

OPERATING SYSTEMS

It's been an eventful year, well filled-out with people gushing over Vista all through its (very) public beta testing programme. Overall, a good idea for the big M—with the whole community getting in on testing, more bugs have been reported and fixed than would ever have been with in-house testing.

As we write this, the news is all over—Windows Vista has “gone gold”—it's ready to hit the markets in the end of January, and anticipation fills the world.

Vista comes with a whole lot of bells and whistles—notably the pretty Aero interface—beyond that, the Vista user experience is going to be much friendlier, and the new ReadyBoost feature will let you use your flash drive to kick up performance as well.

There are still plenty of kinks to be ironed out—especially the impact on gaming performance and the ongoing battle with antivirus companies over the blocked kernel—but 2006 was easily the Year of Vista, for not a month passed by without it being discussed.

The Linux population hasn't been resting either. The ever-increasing popularity of the newbie-friendly Ubuntu has given hope to the community—perhaps there's a lasting place for Linux on the desktop after all. GNOME seems to have taken the lead in the battle of the Desktop Environments, with both SuSE and Fedora Core (which formerly came with KDE) switching loyalties.

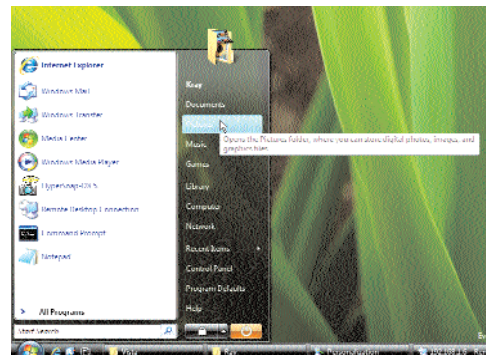
To combat the growing threat of Aero being overly pretty (huh?), Novell came up with their own 3D Desktop—called XGL, it brought an OpenGL-based prettiness never before associated with the Penguin. You can now flip between desktops on a cool 3D cube, in addition enjoying to a truckload of special effects with your windows.

Apple went the Intel way, and naturally, Mac OS X followed. The x86 compatible OS X Tiger meant a lot to hackers (not the malicious kind), who went about happily installing it on their PCs for dual-boot joy, which also led to the release of BootCamp—Apple's way of saying “Don't hack, just use this to get XP on your Intel Mac”. Genius!

Rounding It Off

Excitement is accelerating exponentially, if that were possible. We're hedging our bets on the idea that exciting though 2006 was, '07 will be more so. (The extra broadband we're going to get will help.) The general idea is, time today is Internet time. At this rate, there's got to be a new law to state that each period of time will appeal to the geek's will, wish and wisdom more than the previous one did. ■

ram_mohan@thinkdigit.com



Vista's not all about eye-candy, but it does well in that department



INTEX SPEAKERS WITH CLARIT MATRIX.
EVEN A PINDROP IS CRYSTAL CLEAR.

27 Branches, 51 service Centres, Toll Free No. 1800116789
get info: info@intexindia.com Website: www.intexindia.com

DVD Players

DVD Player R 38 DVD Player R 41 DVD Player R 18

MP3/MP4 Player & FM Modulator

FM Modulator Nova 101 MP3 Player Nova 201 MP3 Player Nova 101 MP4 Player

Cabinet, UPS & USB Flash Drive

Cabinet ZVR Cabinet USB Flash Drive

Subwoofers

4000 W 4000 W 4000 W

Monitors & Personal Computers

Laptop (Celeron 400) Also Available: Pentium 400 AMD Athlon

Also Available: Celeron 400 Pentium 400 AMD Athlon

Keyboard & Mouse

Microsoft Office 2003 Logitech Cyberman Cyberman Cyberman Cyberman

Corporate Office: Intex Technologies (India) Ltd. D-102, Disha Industrial Area, Phase - II, New Delhi - 110015

● Ahmedabad: 9027154500 ● Bangalore: 9342051500 ● Bhubaneswar: 9306154502 ● Chandigarh: 9310233500 ● Chennai: 9444045459 ● Cochin: 9249125450 ● Coimbatore: 9302235971 ● Jaipur: 9338115417 ● Jamnagar: 9418102000 ● Kolkata: 9305545002 ● Lucknow: 9305545001 ● Ludhiana: 9888024480 ● Mumbai: 9244515001 ● Patna: 9343113995 ● Dehradun: 9258121000 ● Delhi: 9312477215 ● Chandigarh: 9311254502 ● Gurgaon: 9200504504 ● Gwalior: 9254445003 ● Indore: 9301545002 ● Jaipur: 9312477215 ● Jalandhar: 9418102000 ● Patna: 9343113995 ● Raipur: 9305545002 ● Secunderabad: 9000944501 ● Surat: 9207154500 ● Bhopal: 9305545002 ● Warangal: 9305545003